Why Tokyo train stations have their own theme tunes



Aidan McFarlane

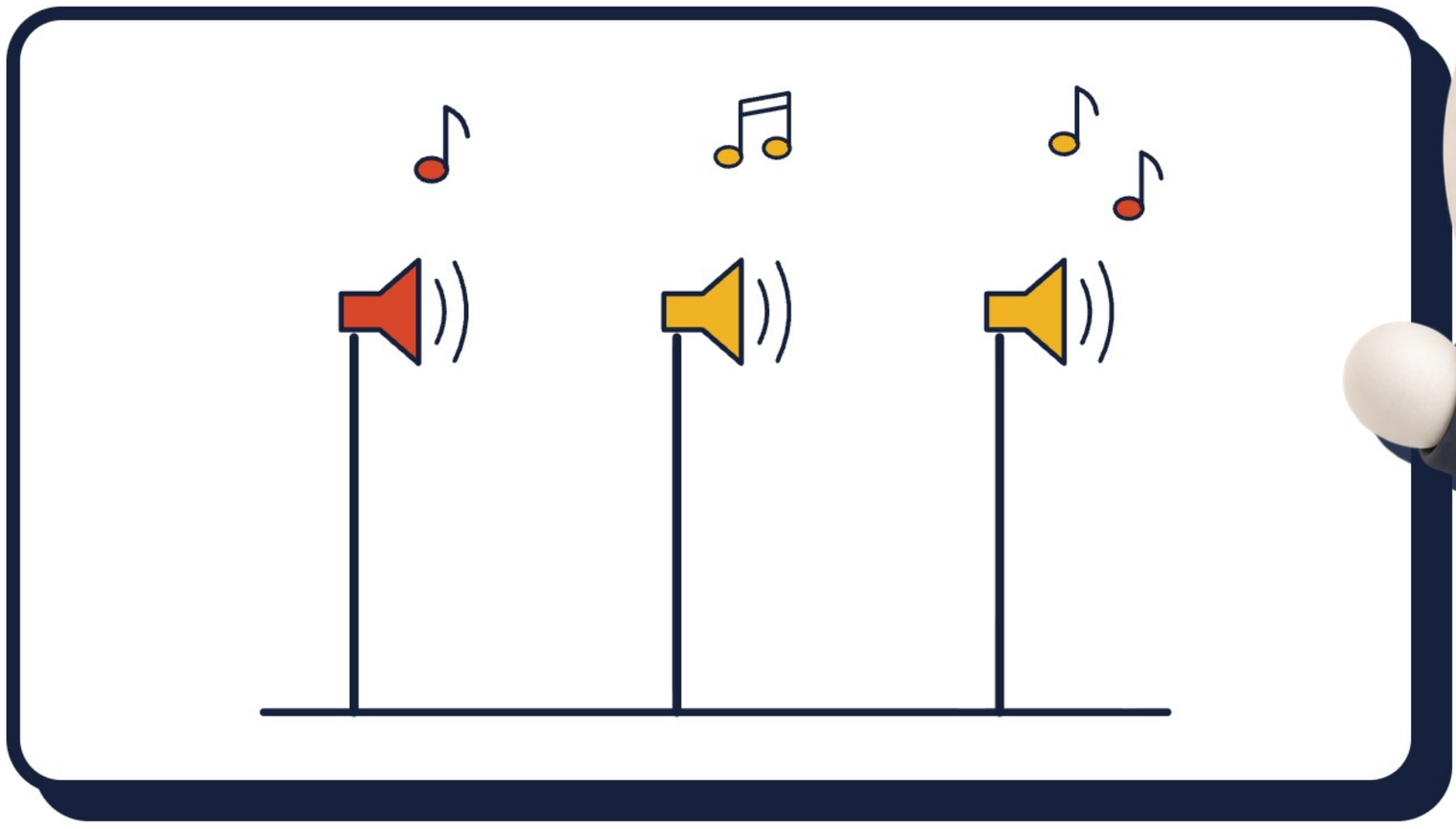
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01

A tune for every station

Many Tokyo stations play a short departure melody instead of a buzzer.

Ebisu plays The Third Man theme, long used in Yebisu beer adverts.





Why it works



Short A few seconds, over before it annoys

Local Tied to a real place or story

Repeated The same moment, every day

02

Takadanobaba plays Astro Boy

Tezuka Productions, the studio behind the character, is based nearby.

A local story turned into a sound people recognise.



- Tied to a real local story
- Gentler than a buzzer

Where your brand could use a sound



App — Opening, purchase, confirmation

Video — The last two seconds of every ad

Space — Events and retail

Your brand probably has a colour. Does it have a sound?

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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